

Open Source Intelligence (OSINT) Assessment Report:

Zepto.com

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Target: Zepto.com
Tester: Akshayavardhan S
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Table of Contents

1. Introduction

1.1 Summary

2. Scope & Methodology

2.1 Scope of Work

2.2 Tools & Techniques

3. Digital Findings

3.1 Domain Footprint

3.2 Network & Hosting Architecture

3.2.1 DNS Records

3.3 SSL/TLS Certificate

3.4 Subdomains

3.5 Publicly Exposed Directories & Files

3.5.1 robots.txt Analysis

3.5.2 sitemap.xml Analysis

3.6 Technology Stack

3.7 URLScan.io

4. Corporate & Financial Findings

4.1 Organizational Structure & Leadership

4.2 Financial Performance (FY26)

4.3 IPO & Fundraising Strategy

5. Data Privacy & Consumer Profiling

- 5.1 Data Collection Inventory
- 5.2 Behavioral & Emotional Profiling Mechanisms
- 5.3 Legal and Regulatory Exposure

6. Intelligence Correlation & Risk Assessment

- 6.1 Cross-Domain Pattern Analysis

7. Strategic Conclusions & Recommendations

- 7.1 Key Intelligence Findings
- 7.2 Recommended Actions

8. Appendix

- 8.1 Subdomain Inventory
- 8.2 robots.txt Extraction
- 8.3 DNS TXT Records
- 8.4 Related Domain Ownership
- 8.5 Source Bibliography

1. Introduction

1.1 Summary

An Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT) investigation was conducted against **Zepto.com** to map its public digital footprint and identify privacy, and regulatory risks.

The investigation revealed a company at a critical inflection point: aggressive growth (revenue doubled to ₹22,623 crore, IPO filing of ₹8,010 crore) is being driven by a data monetization strategy that relies on extensive user profiling including emotional/mood-based targeting, health data collection, and third-party data sharing with partners like The Trade Desk raising significant concerns under India's Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act 2023.

2. Scope & Methodology

2.1 Scope of work

Item	Details
Target	zepto.com and associated domains
Geographic Scope	India
Data Sources	Publicly accessible information only DNS records, WHOIS, subdomain enumerations, robots.txt, sitemap.xml, privacy policies, corporate filings, news reports.
Excluded Activities	Active scanning, vulnerability exploitation, social engineering, or any interaction with Zepto's systems beyond standard public queries
Compliance	All activities conducted in accordance with applicable laws and platform terms of service

2.2 Tools & Techniques

Category	Tools Used	Purpose
Domain & DNS	dnsdumpster.com	WHOIS records, DNS resolution, MX/NS/TXT records
Subdomain Discovery	Subfinder	subdomain enumeration
Services	urlscan.io	Open ports/Services
Technology Fingerprinting	Wappalyser	JavaScript frameworks, hosting providers.
Public File Checks	Manual browser requests	robots.txt, sitemap.xml, .env, .git/HEAD, security.txt
Corporate/Financial	Google News, Moneycontrol, Mint, Business Standard	Financial disclosures, IPO filings, leadership details
Privacy & Regulatory	Privacy policy review, MediaNama, SFLC.in	Data collection practices, DPDP Act compliance, expert analysis

3. Digital Findings

3.1 Domain Footprint

Attribute	Details
Primary Domain	zepto.com
Registrar	Amazon Registrar, Inc.
Creation Date	June 25, 2004
Name Servers	ns-560.awsdns-06.net, ns-351.awsdns-43.com, ns-1927.awsdns-48.co.uk, ns-1061.awsdns-04.org

3.2 Networking & Hosting Architecture

IP Address	Location	Provider	Purpose
13.232.252.78	Mumbai, India	AWS (ASN 16509)	Origin Server
65.8.131.120	United States (Frankfurt edge)	AWS CloudFront	CDN/Edge Delivery
18.238.55.80	United States (JFK edge)	AWS CloudFront	CDN/Edge Delivery

3.2.1 DNS Records

Record Type	Value
• A Records	13.205.189.34, 13.232.252.78, 65.2.198.162
• A Record (www)	18.238.55.80
• A Record (api)	3.171.139.87
• MX Records	1 smtp.google.com (Google Workspace)
• SOA Record	awsdn-hostmaster.amazon.com
• TXT Records	SPF, Google verification, Zoho verification, Zscaler verification, MongoDB verification, Adobe verification, Apple verification, Atlassian verification

3.3 SSL/TLS Certificate

Attribute	Details
• Issuer	Amazon RSA 2048 M01
• Validity Period	December 31, 2025 – January 29, 2027
• Valid For	1 year
• Certificate Type	RSA 2048-bit

3.4 Subdomains

A total of **5** primary subdomains were identified on zepto.com. Additional subdomains were discovered on related domains (zepto.io, zepto.com.au) but are owned by separate entities.

Subdomain	IP Address	Purpose
www.zepto.com	18.238.55.80	Primary web application
api.zepto.com	3.171.139.87	Application Programming Interface
blog.zepto.com	162.159.153.4	Content marketing platform
pages.zepto.com	None	Landing pages
files.zepto.com	None	File storage/asset hosting

3.5 Publicly Exposed Directories & Files

File	URL	Risk
robots.txt	https://zepto.com/robots.txt	Accessible Medium - Exposes internal paths
sitemap.xml	https://zepto.com/sitemap.xml	Accessible Low - Exposes site structure
.env	https://zepto.com/.env	404 Not Found No risk
.git/HEAD	https://zepto.com/.git/HEAD	404 Not Found No risk
security.txt	https://zepto.com/.well-known/security.txt	404 Not Found No risk

3.5.1 robots.txt Analysis

Path	Potential Purpose	Risk
• /account/	User account management	User data exposure risk
• /api/	API endpoints	High value for attackers
• /cart/	Shopping cart logic	Business logic exposure
• /location/	Location services	User location data
• /order/	Order processing	User order data
• /search/	Search functionality	Search patterns exposed
• /*?cart*	Cart parameters	Business logic exposure

3.5.2 Sitemap.xml Analysis

Path	Potential Purpose
• sitemap/categories.xml	Product categories
• sitemap/city-categories.xml	City-specific products
• sitemap/products.xml	All products
• sitemap/recipes.xml	Recipes
• sitemap/brands.xml	Brands
• sitemap/static-pages.xml	Static pages
• sitemap/events.xml	Events
• sitemap/cities-root.xml	Cities
• sitemap/category-pages.xml	Category pages

3.6 Technology stack

Category	Technology
Framework	Next.js
Library	React
UI Framework	Tailwind CSS
Animation	Framer Motion
Performance	Partytown, Priority Hints
Hosting	AWS
CDN	AWS CloudFront
Email	Google Workspace
PWA	Progressive Web App
Open Graph	Yes

3.7 Urlscan.io

- Total Scans (zepto.com) 35
- Total Scans (www.zepto.com) 34
- Earliest Scan 2 years ago
- Latest Scan June 23, 2026
- Security Verdict No classification (not malicious)
- Rate Limiting 429 response detected (WAF protection)

Open Services/Port

- | Service | Port | Status |
|---------|------|------------------------------|
| • HTTP | 80 | Redirects to HTTPS |
| • HTTPS | 443 | CloudFront - ERROR response |
| • SMTP | 25 | Google Workspace (MX record) |

4.0 Corporate & Financial Findings

4.1 Organizational Structure & Leadership

Category	Details
Founders & Promoter Group	Aadit Palicha and Kaivalya Vohra; 19.6% stake
Board of Directors	Aadit Palicha, Kaivalya Vohra, Paul Hudson (Chairman),
Key Executives	Ramesh Bafna (CFO), Anu Hariharan, Akhil Gupta Devendra Meel (CBO), Nikhil Mittal (CTO), Divesh Sawhney (CGO), Sneha Arora (CHRO), Vikas Sharma (COO)

4.2 Financial Performance (FY26)

Metric	FY26	FY25	Change
Operating Revenue	₹22,623.58 crore	₹11,109.94 crore	+104%
Net Loss	₹5,905.19 crore	₹4,699.71 crore	Widened 26%
Total Expenses	₹29,026.7 crore	₹16,241.1 crore	+79%
Per-Order Loss	₹78.75	₹136.15	Narrowed
Advertising Revenue	₹1,636 crore	₹49 crore (FY24)	+3,238%

4.3 IPO & Fundraising Strategy

- Total Issue Fresh issue ₹8,010 crore + OFS of 113.5 million shares
- Founders' Participation Not selling any stake
- Major OFS Sellers Nexus Venture Partners, Contrary Capital,
Kaiser Permanente, Razor Capital
- Use of Proceeds Dark-store expansion, technology infrastructure,
marketing
- Target Listing July 2026 (NSE/BSE)

5. Data Privacy & Consumer Profiling

5.1 Data Collection Inventory

Data Category	Collected	Legal Basis	Source
Health & Lifestyle Data	Yes	Consent by use	Privacy Policy
Browsing & Purchase Behaviour	Yes	Consent by use	Privacy Policy
App Drawer Access	Yes	Permissions	MediaNama
Location Data	Yes	Consent by use	Privacy Policy
Device & Browser Information	Yes	Consent by use	Privacy Policy
Transactional Information	Yes	Consent by use	Privacy Policy

5.2 Behavioral & Emotional Profiling Mechanisms

Feature	Description
PMS Search Experience	Search "PMS" returns mood categories: "Crampy", "Ragey", "Hangry"
Mood-Based Product Bundles Consumer Persona (ATOM)	"Monday Blues" comfort kits AI-powered psychographic profile for brands
App Drawer Access	Can infer health status from period trackers

5.3 Legal & Regulatory Exposure

Issue Relevant	Law	Risk Level
• Consent Model	DPDP Act 2023	Critical - Consent-by-use may not meet free, informed, specific consent standards
• Health Data Collection	DPDP Act 2023	Critical - Sensitive data requires explicit consent
• Cross-Border Transfer	DPDP Act 2023	High - Data shared abroad without specific consent
• Lack of Opt-Out	DPDP Rules 2025	High - No clear opt-out for profiling
• Inferred Data	DPDP Act 2023	High - Emotional profiling falls outside clear legal scope

6. Intelligence Correlation & Risk Assessment

6.1 Cross-Domain Pattern Analysis

Pattern	Evidence Across Domains	Risk
Aggressive Data Collection	Health, lifestyle, app drawer, location, browsing behavior (Privacy Policy, MediaNama)	Users profiled without awareness
Weak Consent Model	"Consent-by-use" rather than explicit opt-in (Privacy Policy)	Potential DPDP Act violation
Data as Revenue Driver	Advertising revenue up 3,238%; ATOM + The Trade Desk (Financials, MediaNama)	User behavior as primary revenue stream
Regulatory Ambiguity	Inferred data (emotions, health) not clearly regulated (Privacy Policy, MediaNama)	Operating in legal gray area
Infrastructure Investment	1,139 dark stores, AWS expansion (Financials, Technical)	Aggressive expansion ahead of IPO
Executive Incentives	Large ESOP grants to CFO, CBO, CHR (Corporate)	Growth prioritized over privacy

7. Strategic Conclusions & Recommendations

7.1 Key Intelligence Findings

The OSINT investigation revealed a company at a critical inflection point:

- **Aggressive Growth Strategy:** Revenue doubled to ₹22,623 crore, dark stores expanded to 1,139, IPO targeted for July 2026.
- **Data Monetization is Core to Business Model:** Advertising revenue surged 3,238% to ₹1,636 crore. ATOM Consumer Persona, The Trade Desk partnership, and mood-based profiling indicate data is central to revenue strategy.
- **Significant Privacy Risks:** Broad data collection, "consent-by-use" model, emotional profiling, and third-party data sharing raise serious concerns under India's DPDP Act 2023.

7.2 Recommended Actions

Critical	Audit data collection practices against DPDP Act requirements; obtain explicit, informed consent for sensitive data	High	Regulatory Risk
Critical	Provide clear, user-friendly opt-out mechanisms for all profiling and data sharing	Medium	Regulatory Risk
High	Disclose how mood/emotional profiling works and what data is inferred	Medium	Reputational Risk
High	Review third-party data sharing agreements, especially with The Trade Desk	Medium	Regulatory Risk
Medium	Remove sensitive paths (/api/, /order/, /account/) from robots.txt	Low	Security Risk
Medium	Implement directory-level authentication for API endpoints	Low	Security Risk
Low	Implement security.txt file for vulnerability disclosure	Low	Security Hygiene
Low	Consider moving subdomains behind Cloudflare to obscure origin IPs	Low	Security Risk

8. Appendix

8.1 Subdomain Inventory

Subdomain	IP	Purpose
www.zepto.com	18.238.55.80	Main website
api.zepto.com	3.171.139.87	API endpoint
blog.zepto.com	162.159.153.4	Blog platform
pages.zepto.com	None	Landing pages
files.zepto.com	None	File storage

8.2 robots.txt Extraction

User-Agent: *

Allow: /

Disallow: /account/

Disallow: /api/

Disallow: /cart/

Disallow: /location/

Disallow: /location-information/

Disallow: /order/

Disallow: /ProcessOrder/

Disallow: /search/

Disallow: /*?cart*

Disallow: /*?z_*

Disallow: /*&z_*

OpenAI

User-Agent: GPTBot

Allow: /

...

8.3 DNS TXT Records

"mongodb-site-verification=XdA65APL1hpRLELKtn68J9HVvOxeBfHf"

"v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com include:amazonses.com ~all"

"atlassian-domain-verification=u/n73jZwezC8CR1fMCDs0IQfiq0226BQypBvui3LiJ8Sfz
PbQTPx01jj7IP75/Vj"

"google-site-verification=BAAdKFvKXQy8sghzwHr74Vvcil2P32FtrCSDXreA9gB4"

"google-site-verification=UCYwYdh2bNx2UqRbi5oQopTCurbQTNw2NUChVOZGKZM"

"zoho-verification=zb87986603.zmverify.zoho.in"

"google-site-verification=79YCa3F7TSD_dcXnlAr74tBDQ32abIM_B35NkaF1n68"

"adobe-idp-site-verification=c2fc85abc17a326871e3edb909fd91459e56d56d0ceflf15dd76
2b73b62634d8"

"zscaler-verification-115895704-21012026-DC3Lmq"

"google-site-verification=78MWcq70mZa3TfjRyXKRJni8oQzd5QccQU8gzgh5YI"

"apple-domain-verification=cvhPJVDix9Mv0ccN"

"atlassian-sending-domain-verification=2089d79f-21b0-4214-9c4e-6751d66fa95a"

8.4 Related Domain Ownership

Domain	Registrar	Registrant	Creation Date
zepto.cn	成都西数科技有限公司	(Chen Bangcai)	2015-11-13
zepto.com.au	Web Address Registration	SPLIT PAYMENTS	Unknown
zepto.io	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown
zepto.co.in	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown

8.5 Source Bibliography

• Zepto Privacy Policy	https://zepto.com/privacy	Legal/Documentation
• urlscan.io	https://urlscan.io/result/	Technical
• subfinder	https://subfinder...	Technical
• dnsdumpster.com	https://dnsdumpster.com/	Technical
• MediaNama Investigation	https://mediamama.in	News/Privacy
• SFLC.in Report	https://sflc.in	Legal/Privacy
• Business Standard	https://business-standard.com	Corporate/Financial
• Mint	https://mint.com	Corporate/Financial
• Moneycontrol	https://moneycontrol.com	Corporate/Financial

End Of Report
